

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	Meditation: the nature, purpose and significance of meditation in Buddhism; the different types of meditation: samatha (concentration), metta bhavana (loving kindness) and vipassana (insight); meditative practices, including mindfulness breathing and zazen, divergent understanding of the nature and importance of visualisation of the Buddha and Bodhisattvas, including Amitāyus Meditation Sutra; how the different practices are used by Mahayana and Theravada Buddhists and the benefits from their use.
3.2	Chanting: the nature, purpose and role of chanting in Buddhism as a devotional practice and to gain mental concentration, including Dhammapada 1–2, confidence and joy. The divergent understandings of the importance of chanting in Buddhist life today: Theravada Buddhism, including Tiratana Buddhism, with reference to Dhammapada 190, and Mahayana Buddhism, including Nam Myoho Renge Kyo.
3.3	Mantra recitation: divergent understandings of the nature, purpose, role and importance of mantra recitation with reference to Theravada Buddhism, including Namo Buddhaya ('Homage to the Buddha'), and Mahayana Buddhism; the nature and purpose of using sacred syllables, devotional articles, offerings and mala beads and why they are used in different schools of Buddhism.
3.4	Features of Buddhist places of worship: the divergent nature, history and design of Buddhist places of worship, including temples, gompas, viharas, shrines in Theravada, Mahayana and Triratna Buddhism; how and why the places of worship are used, including reference to the shrine room, shrine facing east, and the library, showing the importance of learning with reference to the Kimsila Sutta.
3.5	How and why objects of devotion are used within different Buddhist places of worship, buddharupas, including reference to Vakkali Sutta, shrine, Bodhi tree; divergent understandings of why devotional objects are important in Buddhism today.
3.6*	Puja: the nature and purpose of puja in the vihara and the home, including reference to Mangala Sutta; examples of the different types; when each type might be used and why; the importance of having different types of worship and their use in different Buddhist contexts.
3.7	Death and mourning rituals and ceremonies: the divergent celebration and significance of the ceremonies in Buddhist communities and to Buddhists; the distinct significance of the rituals associated with death and mourning in Theravada communities and in Japan and Tibet, with reference to the Tibetan Book of the Dead.
3.8	Festivals and retreats: the divergent nature, history, purpose and importance of festivals and retreats in Buddhism; divergent understandings of the origins, meaning and features of celebration of specific festivals and retreats, including Wesak, Vassa/Rain Retreat and Kathina, with reference to the Anapanasati Sutta, and Uposatha days in Theravada Buddhism; Hanamatsuri and Obon (Japanese), Parinibbana Day in Mahayana Buddhism, and Lama Tsong Khapa Day in Tibet.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Buddhist teachings about the origins and value of the universe: Buddhist responses to scientific explanations for the origins of the universe, including the origins having no significance and reference to <i>The Universe in a Single Atom</i> Chapter 4 by the XIV Dalai Lama; the value of the universe and the natural world in Buddhism; divergent Buddhist responses to and teachings on the possible view that the universe is to be used as a commodity.
4.2	Buddhist teachings about the sanctity of life, including reference to the First Precept in The Khuddakapatha: Buddhist teachings about why human life is special; how life is shown as special in Buddhism; divergent understandings regarding the importance of life for Buddhists today.
4.3	Buddhist responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins and value of human life, including evolution and survival of the fittest, including interpretations of Cula-Malunkya Sutta; divergent understandings of the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Buddhists today.
4.4	Implications of the Buddhist teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: divergent Buddhist teachings about the nature and use of abortion, including the First Precept and New York Times Interview with the Dalai Lama Sunday, December 5, 1993; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Buddhist responses to them.
4.5	Buddhist responses to the existence of death and the afterlife: Buddhist teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death, including the Wheel of Life and the impermanence of the self, including reference to Sahasodgata Avadana, Divyavadana 21; divergent Buddhist responses to arguments for life after death (including remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones); the significance of arguments for belief in life after death for Buddhists.
4.6	Buddhist responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Buddhists reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Brahmajala Sutta 4.
4.7	Implications of Buddhist teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: Buddhist teachings about the nature and use of euthanasia including Vakkali Sutta; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Buddhist responses to them including support for hospice care, including the Buddhist Hospice Trust.
4.8	Buddhist responses to issues in the natural world: Buddhist teachings and responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources, including Dhammapada 270 and The Buddhist Declaration on Nature (Assisi 1986); divergent Buddhist responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, including the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.

Area of Study 1E – Hinduism

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Hinduism as a lived religion within the United Kingdom and throughout the world, and its beliefs and teachings on life, specifically within families, and with regard to matters of life and death.

There are four sections: Hindu Beliefs, Marriage and the Family, Living the Hindu Life and Matters of Life and Death.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices to Hindus today should be explored throughout the sections. This should include reference to how scripture informs a Hindu's understanding of the topics and how approaches to the issues are underpinned by philosophical arguments and ethical theory as applicable.

Students will be expected to study Hinduism within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Hinduism with Christianity as outlined in the content below.

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.5)*
- The practice and significance of worship (3.4)*

Students should recognise that Hinduism is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Judaism, Islam, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of ethics and/or philosophy within Hinduism and non-religious views as outlined in the content below.

Students should also recognise that within Hinduism there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Hinduism in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Shaivism and Vaishnavism.